

OMB Control No: 0970-0114

Expiration date: 03/31/2027

THE PAPERWORK REDUCTION ACT OF 1995 (Pub. L. 104–13)

The purpose of this information collection is the application for CCDF funds and provides ACF and the public with a description of, and assurance about, the States' and Territories' child care programs. Public reporting burden for this collection of information is estimated to average 150 hours per response, including the time for reviewing instructions, gathering, and maintaining the data needed, and completing the form. This is a mandatory collection of information (Pub. L. 113–186), and 42 U.S.C. 9858.

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**Appendix 1: Lead Agency Implementation Plan
for**

State/Territory Maine

FFY 2025 – 2027

Version: Initial Plan

Plan Status: Approved as of 2024-11-09 00:34:15 GMT

For each non-compliance, Lead Agencies must describe the following:

- **Action Steps:** List the action steps needed to correct the finding (e.g., update policy manual, legislative approval, IT system changes, etc.). For each action step list the:
 - o **Expected Completion Date:** List the expected completion date for the action step.
- **Overall Target Date for Compliance:** List date Lead Agency anticipates completing implementation, achieving full compliance with all aspects of the findings. (Note: Compliance will not be determined until the FFY 2025-2027 CCDF Plan is amended and approved).

EQUAL ACCESS:AFFORDABILITY

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency does not limit all family co-payments to seven percent or less of family income, as required by 98.45(l)(3). (Plan Question 3.1.1a). Please note the Lead Agency has an approved waiver for this requirement through March 31, 2026.

Overall Target Completion Date: 05/19/2025

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	The Department is in process of building an integrated Child Care Management System, Baxter, which will help to manage provider payments amongst other interactions for families and providers on the CCAP program. Limiting co-payments to seven percent or less for all eligible families at 85% and below State Median Income (SMI) is built into this system and will roll out when this system goes live.	05/19/2025
2	CCAP rules are being updated to reflect a cap at 7% or less of family income for those eligible for CCDF funds at 85% or less of SMI.	05/19/2025

EQUAL ACCESS:PAYMENT PRACTICES

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency does not pay all provider types prospectively or alternatively does not demonstrate that it is not a generally-accepted practice for all provider types, as required by 98.45(m)(1). (Plan Question 4.4.1a). Please note the Lead Agency has an approved waiver for this requirement through March 31, 2026.
- The Lead Agency does not pay providers based on enrollment or alternatively does not provide justification that this is impracticable or is not a generally-accepted practice, as required by 98.45(m)(2). (Plan Question 4.4.1b). Please note the Lead Agency has an approved waiver for this requirement through March 31, 2026.

Overall Target Completion Date: 05/19/2025

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	The Department is in process of building an integrated Child Care Management System, Baxter, which will help to manage provider payments and will be used to pay providers prospectively and by enrollment once it goes live.	05/19/2025
2	Change our State CCAP rules to include prospective payment policies.	05/19/2025
3	Change our State CCAP rules to include paying by enrollment rather than attendance.	05/19/2025
4	Change internal protocols and procedures and train staff accordingly to align with a smooth transition to these two new payment practices.	05/19/2025

EQUAL ACCESS:PROVIDER OPTIONS FOR PARENTS

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency does not provide grants or contracts for direct services for infants and toddlers, for children in underserved geographic areas, and for children with disabilities, as required by 98.30(b)(1). (Plan Questions 4.1.1c and 4.5.1i). Please note the Lead Agency has an approved waiver for this requirement through March 31, 2026.

Overall Target Completion Date: 03/31/2026

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	Research and review areas of the State that fall under geographically underserved areas using the latest Gap Analysis as well as other demographic information.	02/28/2025
2	Create an Access and Stabilization Strategy for how we use Grants and Contracts according to the above researched information and in relationship to serving infants and toddlers as well	06/30/2025

	as children with disabilities. This includes identifying potential programs to partner with in the administration of grants and contracts.	
3	Create MOUs to utilize with programs and get them approved by State administrators.	09/30/2025
4	Fully execute and implement the MOUs for grants and contracts within the State	03/31/2026

EQUAL ACCESS:SUPPLY BUILDING STRATEGIES

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency does not adequately describe how they identify gaps in the supply of child care during non-traditional hours, as required by 98.16(x). (Plan Question 4.5.4d)

Overall Target Completion Date: 05/30/2025

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	We currently do track programs who offer non-traditional hours of care if they participate in the CCAP program.	12/26/2024
2	The Department will update the State Plan with that data to fully illustrate the way we collect and analyze non traditional hours care.	05/30/2025

HEALTH AND SAFETY:PREVENTION AND CONTROL OF INFECTIOUS DISEASES

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency has not established a standard for immunizations for license-exempt in-home providers, as required by 98.41(a)(1)(i). (Plan Question 5.3.1bvi)

Overall Target Completion Date: 05/19/2025

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	CCAP is updating our rules to include the immunization requirement for license-exempt in-home providers.	05/19/2025
2	We will update our verbiage in provider agreements to reflect this rule change as soon as it goes into effect.	05/19/2025

PROGRAM INTEGRITY:FRAUD INVESTIGATION, PAYMENT RECOVERY, AND SANCTIONS

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency does not include the results of the activities to identify program violations, as required by 98.68(b)(1). (Plan Question 10.2.1)

Overall Target Completion Date: 12/31/2025

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	Review the information we do have related to identifying program violations. Review what information we would like to have that is missing.	02/28/2025
2	Review information from TA on other lead agency examples of program integrity and accountability	02/28/2025
3	Create a plan for a more robust and unified approach to eligibility review, fraud detection, and program integrity across our team. Train staff on approach and implement new guidelines for eligibility specialists.	06/30/2025
4	Fully implement plan created in Step 3	12/31/2025